

5.3 Homeostasis

Homeostasis involves co-ordination which may be chemical or electrical. The aim of this section is to consider the principles of homeostasis with reference to the control of heart rate, body temperature and blood glucose concentration. The implications of a failure of homeostatic mechanisms are also considered.

Learners gain an understanding of the kidney as an organ of homeostasis and excretion, and the effects of kidney disease, and diabetes, are studied.

The ethics of organ donation and the potential uses of cloning and stem cell technology in treatments are also considered.

Learners are expected to apply knowledge, understanding and other skills gained in this section to new situations and/or to solve related problems.